

Build Your Own Home-Grown NAS with an Old Computer

For those wondering if they could get rid of all the external hard drives and cables lying around, or find a way to use that ancient CPU or laptop gathering dust in a cupboard, a Linux server could be the answer. Servers are incredibly useful even at home. This article demonstrates how to set up a home server for media streaming and back-ups.



What are servers, and why do I need one? A server is often just a computer that stores your data and serves it to other computers on the network. In a household scenario, it can be hidden away in a corner of your room—a target for all your device backups, and source for all your media to your devices. Specifically, such a set-up is called Network-Attached Storage (NAS).

There are a lot of out-of-the-box solutions to create a

NAS, but most of them are very expensive or don't even come close to the kind of customisability that Ubuntu Linux can provide. Ubuntu is one of the best and the easiest to install and use flavours of Linux, and that is why we are using it for our NAS box.

So what do you need to get started? There are different versions of Ubuntu available, and most should work fine for our purposes, but in this article, we will follow the easiest method of installation. This is what you will need: